



“NOT JUST INDUSTRIALISATION, BUT INDUSTRY-LED URBANISATION”

NICDC CEO & MD Rajat Kumar Saini talks about the plan for the new industrial cities and their impact

BY **SURABHI** PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

THE NATIONAL INDUSTRIAL Corridor Development Corporation (NICDC) has been spearheading the development of eight industrial cities, four of which have been completed and have seen good interest from investors. CEO and MD Rajat Kumar Saini, 40, believes the 12 new industrial parks recently approved by the cabinet will also see a good response and help India take forward its plans to become a global manufacturing hub. Edited excerpts:



What is the plan for the 12 industrial parks and the expected completion date?

We like to call them industrial areas, or industrial cities, not industrial parks, considering the philosophy of the government that it is not just industrialisation, but also industry-led urbanisation. The government approved these after the initial success of eight such parks that are already under the NICDC. Not a lot of people are aware, but Dholera, the first semiconductor city of India,

is also under NICDC. Four such cities are already up and running... Over 300 industries have been allotted land here, of which 100 have started production.

State governments will be equal partners in developing these 12 new industrial cities. For every project, we [will] float a joint venture company or a special purpose vehicle, where both the centre and state have

50% equity each. States [will] also delegate a lot of local body powers, including building and planning. We take environmental clearances beforehand. The state government brings land, and the central government brings money to build infrastructure. If there is any shortfall in money, then we also give debt cover. It is a corporate structure based on co-operative federalism.

